

Sky is the Limit in Telecom

India has about 920 million telecom subscribers, adding about twelve million subscribers on a monthly basis. So telecom is clearly one of the fastest growing industries in India. Does one still need a better reason to make career in telecommunications engineering?



DIKSHA P GUPTA

Telecommunications engineering is currently the hottest branch of engineering in India. At the risk of being immodest, one can say that the scope of this engineering will last forever in an economy like India.

Alok Sinha, an industry professional working as an assistant vice president-general business sales and IT solutions, Huawei, says, "There is no place to be born on this planet better than India for people who want to make a career in telecommunications engineering. The entire Middle East and Saudi Arabia has around 24 million subscribers. UAE has seven million subscribers. We add 12 million subscribers per month. So India adds as many subscribers in a month as the entire subscribers base in some of the countries of the world."

"From the perspective of popula-

tion penetration we have reached just 0.7-0.8 per cent, while for the rest of the world it is around 1.5 to 2 per cent. So we can very well assume that there is still enough to leverage from core telephony," he adds.

A sustainable career option

Though India has 76 per cent teledensity, compared to its BRIC peers, the country's infrastructure still requires a major improvement. Hence in a market that still requires growth impetus, the demand for telecommunications engineers will remain resilient.

Reema Malhotra, head of HR (India), Nokia Siemens Networks, informs, "With new access technologies and the huge growth in the number of subscribers, the next decade will see unprecedented growth in mobile telephony. In recent years, traffic levels have grown manifolds. This trend is

expected to continue well into the future, again bringing opportunities and changing the face of communications as we know it. This growth is expected to provide a sky of career opportunities to telecommunication engineers."

Demand of manpower is growing exponentially in telecommunication sector. However, there has been a paradigm shift of resource requirements to different verticals within the telecommunication industry. Demand of engineers, which was more in handset, network implementation and maintenance segments of the industry in early 2000s, is now migrating towards application development, data networking and value-added services (VAS).

Rajeev Kabra, director and chief executive officer, Cognitel, says, "With new areas like mobile money, mobile advertising and mobile health-care opening up, we expect to see an increase in lateral hiring in telecommunication industry. This hiring will include a major chunk of telecommunication engineers."

It's not just about talent, but the right kind of talent!

For those wanting to get into telecom, there are a plethora of colleges waiting for you across India offering courses in telecommunications engineering.

Pramod Patil, registrar, Dr DY Patil Institute of Engineering and Technology, Pimpri, Pune, says, "The aspirants should make a choice meticulously. Any college which is at least three years ahead in terms of technology is an ideal place for a student as the industry expects the students to have a thorough knowledge of the present technology and clear vision about the futuristic technology."